

Singer of Life

Text: From a Texcoco Nahuatl poem

Music: Plains Indian traditional, 1879

LACQUIPARLE irregular

The musical score is written on three staves in 2/2 time, with a key signature of one flat (B-flat). The melody is simple and folk-like, with a mix of quarter and half notes. Chords are indicated above the staff: Dm (D minor) and Gm (G minor). The lyrics are written below the staff, with some words hyphenated across lines. The first line of music corresponds to the first two lines of the first verse. The second line of music corresponds to the first two lines of the second verse. The third line of music corresponds to the first two lines of the third verse. The score ends with a double bar line.

Dm Gm Dm

1 Sing - er of Life, all flow - ers are songs, with pet - als do you write.
2 Mor - tal are we, with all liv - ing things, with ea - gles in the sky.

Dm Gm Dm

Sing - er of Life, you col - or the earth, daz - zling the eye with birds red and bright.
E - ven all gold and jade will not last; sing - ing a - lone, I know, can - not die.

Dm Gm Dm

Joy is for us! The flow - ers are spread! Sing - ing is our de - light!
Here in this house of spring - time be - stow songs that like birds can fly.